Taehun Kim

Staff Data Scientist 10 years in data science

Coupang | May 2022 - present

NYSE-listed / Fortune 500 #132 (2026) / 24.7M Product Commerce active customers (Q2 2026)

I build AI products for financial services, combining hands-on modeling with product decisions, risk trade-offs, and business evaluation. At Coupang, I lead work across lending, fraud prevention, and GenAI tools - from defining the problem to launch, adoption, and ongoing improvement.

> My focus: deciding what is worth building, developing the solution, and making it useful in day-to-day decisions.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Kimberly-Clark | Senior Data Scientist

D2C prediction and recommendation models; global marketing data standardization.

IBM | Data Scientist

Automotive-parts forecasting POC with data scientists in the UK, Germany, and Japan.

Hana Institute of Technology | Data Scientist

Small-business credit scoring, robo-advisory, and marketing automation.

AI and data research arm of Hana Financial Group, one of Korea's four major financial groups.

EDUCATION

UC San Diego

Master's degree / Econometrics focus

Peking University

Bachelor's degree / International Relations

TEACHING, WRITING & RESEARCH

Adjunct Professor | Ajou University

Mar 2025 - present

Graduate AI program - Understanding Financial AI / AI System Design

Author | Financial AI in Practice | Manning

Kaggle Notebooks Grandmaster

Research

Workshop papers on LLMs for credit and fraud (ICLR 2026, KDD 2026)

Program Committee, ACM SAC 2027 (AIFT track)

LANGUAGES

Korean / Native

Mandarin Chinese / Native

English / Working proficiency

From business problems to working products.

CATEGORY	PROJECT	BUSINESS OBJECTIVE	MODELING / ARCHITECTURE	MY OWNERSHIP	BUSINESS IMPACT / EVALUATION
Operations	**AI analytics platform** Ongoing	Enable self-service analytics; free BA capacity.	Text-to-SQL; graph-structured SQL / DAG knowledge; RAG, MCP, vLLM.	Prioritized use cases; led development, rollout, training, and feedback.	**~70% fewer ad hoc BA tickets;** continuous iteration. Target: >=80% task completion within 3 turns.
Lending	**MCA: launch risk framework**	Launch seller lending without repayment history.	Stop-selling proxies; sales-based repayment simulation; shared seller feature layer.	Defined proxy labels and risk tiers; shaped lending decisions with policy teams.	Enabled cold-start launch with expected loss within the agreed target range.
Lending	**MCA: forecasts & early risk**	Maximize risk-adjusted profitability within risk appetite.	Transformer sales forecasts, P10/P50/P90; early-risk and seller-collapse models.	Shaped limit policies using forecast quantiles, risk signals, and seller tiers.	**Estimated ~10% increase in risk-adjusted margin (RAM)** within the agreed risk appetite.
Lending	**BNPL scoring**	Control delinquency using platform behavior.	Application and behavioral scores; bureau data and platform behavior.	Built both scoring models and risk tiers for BNPL operations.	**Delinquency ~7% to <3%;** behavior-only models sustained roughly 3%.
Lending	**Small-business credit** Hana Institute of Technology	Improve small-business risk differentiation.	ML application scoring with property, card, and other alternative data.	Developed scoring models and translated scores into credit grades.	**AUC improved from the 0.70s to the low 0.80s** against bureau benchmarks.
Fraud	**Payment FDS / KR / TW**	Protect payments while keeping manual review manageable.	Supervised / anomaly models; capacity simulations, reason codes, urgent queues.	Replaced rule-only routing with risk-ranked reviews and capacity-based thresholds.	**Review volume ~90% lower** in an overloaded queue; urgent cases prioritized.
Fraud	**Overseas-card acceptance**	Manage cold-start risk for overseas cards.	Country-level risk signals; surrogate models; chargeback monitoring.	Set initial thresholds and iterated with emerging fraud / chargeback data.	**Chargeback rate <0.3%** - less than one-tenth of the ~3% reference benchmark.
Fraud	**TW multi-account abuse**	Detect networks bypassing promotional purchase limits.	Neo4j and Louvain communities; daily to 6-hour / 3-hour monitoring.	Introduced graph detection; connected investigation workflows with account-policy discussions.	Observed multi-account coupon abuse was largely eliminated.
Fraud	**GenAI review assistance** Ongoing / experimental	Reduce investigation effort while retaining novel-fraud sensitivity.	LLM review with graph context; guided and open-pattern review paths.	Designed review assistance and experiments on prompt anchoring and novel patterns.	*Review effort and novel-pattern recall under evaluation; ongoing iteration.*
Investing	**Robo-advisor** Hana Institute of Technology	Launch an ML-driven investment product.	US ETF direction prediction and portfolio optimization.	Built prediction models; contributed to portfolio design and validation.	Passed the national robo-advisor testbed and reached product launch.
Marketing	**AutoML automation** Hana Institute of Technology	Automate repeatable marketing analytics.	AutoML-based predictive modeling tools.	Contributed modeling and automation for marketing workflows.	Automated parts of the marketing analysis workflow.

MCA: merchant cash advance / BNPL: buy now, pay later / FDS: fraud detection system / BA: business analyst. Rounded project observations; RAM increase is an estimate. The ~3% chargeback comparison is a project reference benchmark. Targets and experimental work are labeled.